

词汇: *sport* 体育比赛

- 1 Use of technology in sports is supposed to be able to provide accurate and instant **feedback**, with better decision-making and reduced errors compared to **human intervention**. But is that always the case?
- 2 The annual tennis **tournament** Wimbledon made the decision this year to replace their **line judges**. These have traditionally been men and women who judge whether the ball is in or **out of bounds**, but they were **switched out** for **AI** that analyses camera footage, which should be faster and more accurate. Despite this, the **electronic line calling system** failed just a week into the 2025 championship. The **ball-tracking** technology was turned off by a person accidentally. This meant a **point** had to be replayed, which resulted in Sonay Kartal controversially winning the game. If technology needs humans to operate it in the first place, whose fault is it in situations like these where things go wrong?
- 3 In football, **referees** often **come under fire** for their decision-making. But **VAR**, that's 'video assistant referee', is regularly used in football these days too. A referee can ask for a VAR check, which means that if they are unsure of something, like the awarding of a **penalty**, they can **double-check** their own judgement. However, last football season, VAR made **oversights** which angered a lot of managers, players and fans. They said the system was not **fit for purpose** and even **favoured** some teams over others. Despite this, the Premier League's chief football officer, Tony Scholes, said during the middle of last year's **season** that standards were actually higher than ever. "Before VAR, 82% of the decisions made were deemed to be correct. In the season so far, that figure is 96%," he said.
- 4 So, why do we still not trust technology if it often improves a situation? Professor Gina Neff from Cambridge University says that we have a very strong, **in-built** sense of fairness. "The machine makes decisions based on the set of rules it's been **programmed** to **adjudicate**," she said. "Right now, in many areas where AI is touching our lives, we feel like humans understand the context much better than the machine."
- 5 Whether you trust it or not, technology is here to stay, including in the world of sport.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. A human error
- b. We can't change the future
- c. Mistrust in tech
- d. A mismatch of beliefs in accuracy
- e. Short-term changes
- f. How do they compare?

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Wimbledon replaced line judges with AI this year.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

2. The match that Sonay Kartal won was controversial because...

- a. she only won because of a human-caused error.
- b. she won despite technology failing.
- c. she won in a replay that was not needed.

3. VAR is used in football...

- a. in replacement of a referee.
- b. to support referees who are unsure of their decisions.
- c. to the anger of managers, players and fans.

4. What does 'this' refer to in the following sentence? *Despite **this**, the Premier League's chief football officer, Tony Scholes, said during the middle of last year's season that standards have never been higher.*

- a. referees making oversights
- b. the football season changing
- c. VAR oversights and the subsequent anger

5. VAR has caused there to be less accurate decision-making by referees.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Plenty of technology is used in sport. **1)** _____ assists referees in football, and this year **2)** _____ were replaced with a technology that is supposedly faster and more **3)** _____. Though it doesn't always go smoothly, and technology has even been accused of **4)** _____ some teams over others because of **5)** _____ it's made.

trust	under fire	accurate
line judges		oversights
favouring		VAR

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

feedback	反馈
human intervention	人工干预
tournament	锦标赛
line judge	边线裁判
out of bounds	在界外，出界
switch out	替换
AI (artificial intelligence)	人工智能
electronic line calling system	电子边线裁判系统
ball-tracking	球运动轨迹追踪
point	分，得分
referee	裁判
come under fire	遭到批评
VAR (video assistant referee)	视频助理裁判
penalty	判罚
double-check	复查
oversight	失察，疏漏
fit for purpose	适合做某事的，发挥预期作用的
favour	偏袒
season	赛季
in-built	与生俱来的，内在的
programme	设置
adjudicate	裁决

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **f) How do they compare?**

Paragraph 2 **a) A human error**

Paragraph 3 **d) A mismatch of beliefs in accuracy**

Paragraph 4 **c) Mistrust in tech**

Paragraph 5 **b) We can't change the future**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. True.** The annual tennis **tournament** Wimbledon made the decision **this year** to **replace their line judges**.

2. **a.** The ball-tracking **technology** was **turned off by a person** accidentally meaning a point was replayed, **which resulted in** Sonay Kartal controversially winning the game.

3. **b.** A **referee** can **ask for a VAR check**, which means that if they are unsure of something, they can **double-check their own judgement**.

4. **c.** However, last football season, **VAR made oversights** which **angered** a lot of managers, players and fans.

5. **b. False.** "**Before VAR 82%** of the **decisions** made were **deemed to be correct**. In the season **so far**, that figure is **96%**."

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Plenty of technology is used in sport. **VAR** assists referees in football, and this year **line judges** were replaced with a technology that is supposedly faster and more **accurate**. Though it doesn't always go smoothly, and technology has even been accused of **favouring** some teams over others because of **oversights** it's made.